Chidinma Okeke

Senior Associate, Corporate and Commercial Law

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Professional summary

Corporate and commercial solicitor with eight years' experience advising private equity sponsors, strategic buyers and growth companies on acquisitions, joint ventures and restructurings. Known for clear, commercially minded advice and for running complex transaction workstreams from first draft to completion. Seeking a counsel or senior associate role with a partnership track at an international practice.

Professional experience

Marlowe Quinn LLP, London

Oct 2021 – Present

Senior Associate, Corporate (since April 2024); Associate (October 2021 to March 2024)

- Lead associate on 14 transactions with a combined value of £1.3 billion, mainly private equity buy-outs and mid-market acquisitions.
- Run deal teams of up to four associates and trainees from due diligence through signing and completion, and manage client communication on matters from £20M to £340M.
- Supervise two trainees each seat and lead the firm's quarterly M&A know-how sessions.
- Co-authored the firm's National Security and Investment Act playbook, now used on all inbound deals.

Hallam & Strand LLP, London

Sep 2015 – Sep 2021

Associate (September 2018 to September 2021); Trainee Solicitor (September 2016 to August 2018); Paralegal (September 2015 to August 2016)

- Acted on 20+ transactions, including cross-border share and asset purchases, joint ventures and management buy-outs.
- Seconded for six months in 2020 to the in-house legal team of a FTSE 250 client, supporting the disposal of two subsidiaries.
- Drafted and negotiated shareholders' agreements, disclosure letters and ancillary documents on deals of up to £120M.

Selected transactions

Matter	Value	Role
Alder Capital: acquisition of Routewise Group, a logistics software provider	£210M	Lead associate on diligence, SPA and disclosure
Norvik Energy: offshore wind services joint venture	£85M	Negotiated shareholders' agreement and governance
Confidential client: take-private of a UK-listed retailer	£340M	Led legal diligence across 11 jurisdictions
Calder Packaging: management buy-out	£48M	Advised the management team

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Education

Legal Practice Course, Distinction — 2014 – 2015
London College of Legal Practice

LLB (Hons) Law, First Class — 2011 – 2014
Westfield University

Admission and memberships

Solicitor of England and Wales — Admitted September 2018

The Law Society — Member

Association of Women Solicitors London — Member since 2019

Pro bono and community

Volunteer solicitor, Southbank Legal Advice Centre — 2019 – Present
Monthly employment and small-business advice clinic; mentor to two first-generation law students.

Publications and speaking

Take-privates and the Takeover Code: a practical guide — 2023
Corporate Counsel Quarterly, co-authored with a Marlowe Quinn partner.

Panel speaker, Mid-Market Deals Forum — 2024
National security screening in private equity transactions.

Professional development

Leadership programme for senior associates — 2025

Advanced M&A negotiation course — 2023

Skills and languages

- Mergers and acquisitions
- Private equity buy-outs
- Joint ventures
- Shareholder agreements
- Corporate governance
- National security and investment filings

English	Native
Igbo	Fluent
French	Intermediate

References

Available on request.